every two minutes until the Fines Master decided to take mercy on you. So ja, you can get pissed pretty quickly.

Everyone would get a chance to nominate an individual for a fine. You'd have to outline the precise nature of the offence, but you had to be careful. If the Fines Master decided that your nomination wasn't good enough or it was just plain stupid, *you'd* have to drink.

There are other rules, such as 'spillage', which meant that you couldn't spill any beer down your chin when downing it. If you did, you'd have to drink another. I must tell you, though, that I'm proud to say that the guys can really handle it. They don't spill much. In fact, there are a couple of guys – did someone mention André Nel? – who would impress even Oktoberfest stalwarts with the speed and efficiency with which they can down a beer.

It was at this particular fines meeting that poor Mickey got nailed. Funny – American football teams pour a bucket of Gatorade over their coach when they win a big game … we get ours as drunk as a lord. The guys were gunning for Mickey at that fines meeting, and he had to down three ice-cold beers in quick succession. It's tough to recover when you jump the start like that. Those chilled beers just murder you. Mickey was sitting there, leaning against one of the dressing-room lockers, when he just unleashed … all over his chest. I can't say that I've seen a coach vomit like that too many times in my career. To Mickey's great credit, though, he simply fetched a towel, cleaned himself up and carried on.

It was just such a hell of a thing, the fines meeting that night. Even André Nel – he didn't play that game, but was part of the squad – was paralytic, and Nella is a guy who can handle his drink as much as anyone I've ever seen. I remember him standing up to say something … and no one could understand a bladdy word. He might have been speaking English, but he didn't make any sense. We were like, 'No, boet, I think it's time for you to sit down.'

I was really flying as well. We stayed at the Wanderers for a long time that evening. Some of the boys and I went to go and sit on the wicket itself. There we were, in the pitch-dark, after what had been a phenomenal day's cricket.

After we left the ground, we got together with the Australian team for a few drinks, as we usually do after a match. The venue, somewhat ironically, was the Sandton Sun bar. It was like I'd come full circle, ending the